

— THE ARCHIVE

THE 1994 WORLD CUP QUIETLY REWIRED FOOTBALL'S ECONOMICS.

A corporate experiment that changed the game.

A 5-part breakdown

SWIPE ►►►

0101 / 05

| THE GAMBLE.

FIFA handed it to a country with no top league. The goal: crack the biggest media market on earth. *Sport second, market first.*

0202 / 05

| THE RECORD.

Average crowd: 68,991 a match. Still the highest ever, with only 24 teams. *Thirty years on, unbeaten.*

0303 / 05

| THE TV SHIFT.

US networks and sponsors demanded American-style production. Optimised ad breaks, on-screen branding. *Football, packaged.*

0404 / 05

| THE LEGACY.

1994's profits fuelled the modern Champions League push. FIFA chose market expansion over heritage. *The template for everything since.*

0505 / 05

| THE MONEY JUMP.

Sponsorship revenue spiked from Italia '90 to USA '94. *The moment the game went corporate.*

— THE TAKEAWAY

SAVIOUR OR **SELL-OUT?**

Save this archive. Did 1994 save football's finances, or start the over-commercialisation? Tell us — follow @thearchv_ca.